

Monsoon data must be local, actionable

This is the one piece of news India **awaits** around this time of year - because the monsoon is the nation's **elixir**. Earlier this week, Skymet announced that the country is **likely** to receive a normal southwest monsoon this year. It's exactly what everyone wanted to hear, **given** that agriculture is still **overwhelmingly rain-fed**. However, there is a catch: country-level **projections** do not capture the high degree of **spatial** and **temporal** variation in rainfall that has become **par for the course** with **global warming**. A normal monsoon **outlook** can **mask** both dry and wet extremes, which carry serious **implications** for farmers, industry and food prices. What the most important users of weather forecasts now require are localised, district- and tehsil-level projections they can work with.

Over the past 40 years, India has experienced 29 normal, 8 above-normal, and 3 below-normal monsoon years. But a district-level analysis shows a more **fractured** picture: around 30% of districts have faced a high number of **deficient** rainfall years, while 38% have **experienced** frequent excess rainfall. A deeper **div**e into recent data **reveals** that, in the past **decade**, 11% of tehsils have seen a rainfall decline of more than 10% compared to baseline levels. **Many** of these tehsils **lie** in the Indo-Gangetic plains, which **account for** over half of India's agricultural output.



Also worth noting is the dangerous interaction between extreme heat and **erratic** rainfall - 84% of districts are now heatwave **hotspots**, with 70% also experiencing unstable monsoons. This **potent mix** of high temperatures and humidity during the monsoon months **affects** agricultural and human productivity. As temperatures rise and climate impacts **intensify**, the need for localised weather data will only grow. IMD must **accelerate** efforts to make such data accessible and actionable.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'. [\[Practice Exercise\]](#)
- **Rain-fed** (adjective) – supplied with water by natural rainfall alone. वर्षा आधारित

Vocabulary

1. **Await** (verb) – expect, anticipate, look forward to, wait for, be prepared for
इंतज़ार करना
2. **Elixir** (noun) – cure-all, life-saver, solution, panacea, miracle remedy अमृत / जीवन रक्षक
3. **Likely** (adjective) – probable, expected, anticipated, possible, projected संभवतः
4. **Given** (preposition) – considering, in view of, taking into account, owing to, because of देखते हुए
5. **Overwhelmingly** (adverb) – predominantly, primarily, largely, majorly, extensively अत्यधिक रूप से
6. **Projection** (noun) – forecast, prediction, estimate, outlook, expectation पूर्वानुमान
7. **Spatial** (adjective) – geographical, positional, locational, dimensional, area-based स्थानिक
8. **Temporal** (adjective) – time-related, chronological, seasonal, duration-based, timely कालिक
9. **Par for the course** (phrase) – typical, expected, routine, standard, usual सामान्य बात
10. **Global warming** (noun) – the increase in the temperature of the earth's atmosphere, caused by the increase of certain gases वैश्विक ऊष्मीकरण
11. **Outlook** (noun) – forecast, perspective, expectation, prediction, view दृष्टिकोण
12. **Mask** (verb) – hide, cover, conceal, obscure, disguise छुपाना
13. **Implication** (noun) – consequence, effect, result, outcome, significance प्रभाव / निहितार्थ
14. **Fractured** (adjective) – broken, divided, fragmented, split, inconsistent खंडित
15. **Deficient** (adjective) – lacking, insufficient, inadequate, scarce, meager कमी वाला
16. **Experience** (verb) – undergo, face, encounter, go through, live through अनुभव करना
17. **Dive** (noun) – deep analysis, investigation, exploration, examination, scrutiny गहन अध्ययन
18. **Decade** (noun) – Period of ten years दसक
19. **Lie** (verb) – be located, exist, be situated, rest, be present स्थित होना
20. **Account for** (phrasal verb) – constitute, comprise, represent, contribute, form बनाना

21. **Erratic** (adjective) – unpredictable, unstable, irregular, inconsistent, fluctuating अस्थिर

22. **Hotspot** (noun) – danger zone, high-risk area, center of activity, focal point, critical zone संवेदनशील क्षेत्र

23. **Potent** (adjective) – powerful, strong, intense, effective, forceful शक्तिशाली

24. **Intensify** (verb) – increase, heighten, strengthen, escalate, amplify तेज़ करना

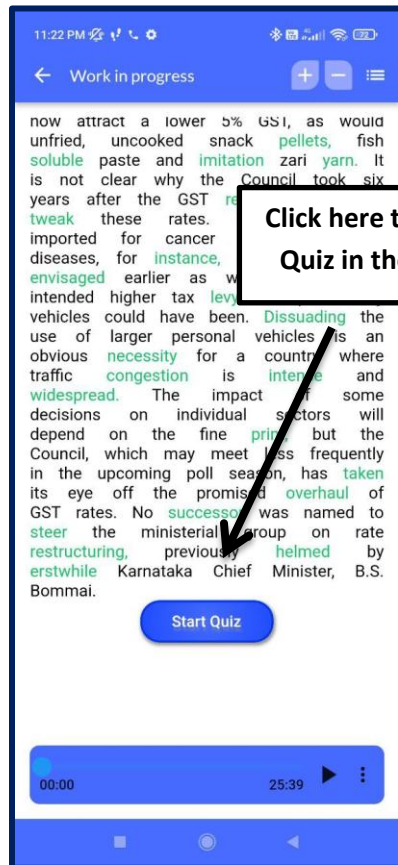
25. **Accelerate** (verb) – speed up, hasten, quicken, expedite, advance तेज़ी लाना

@mocks_wallah

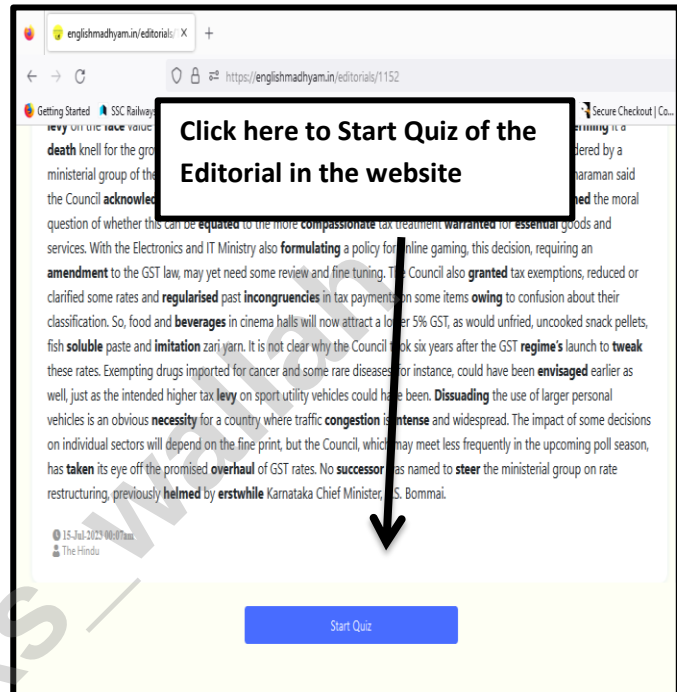
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Monsoon as lifeline** – The Indian monsoon is crucial for the country, especially because agriculture is heavily rain-dependent.
2. **Skymet forecast** – Skymet has predicted a normal southwest monsoon for the year, providing relief to various sectors.
3. **National vs. local projections** – National-level monsoon forecasts are insufficient due to high spatial and temporal rainfall variability.
4. **Climate change impact** – Global warming has intensified rainfall irregularities, leading to extremes even within “normal” monsoon years.
5. **Hidden extremes** – A “normal” monsoon at the national level may still mask regional droughts or floods, affecting farmers, industries, and food prices.
6. **Need for granular data** – There is a growing demand for district- and tehsil-level forecasts to make decisions more effective.
7. **Historical trend** – Over 40 years, India has recorded 29 normal, 8 above-normal, and 3 below-normal monsoon years.
8. **Fractured rainfall reality** – Despite national averages, 30% of districts had frequent deficient rainfall, while 38% had excessive rainfall episodes.
9. **Tehsil-level concerns** – In the past decade, 11% of tehsils experienced over 10% rainfall decline, showing worrying localized trends.
10. **Agricultural impact zone** – Most affected tehsils are in the Indo-Gangetic plains, responsible for over 50% of India’s farm output.
11. **Heatwave-monsoon interaction** – 84% of districts are now heatwave hotspots, with 70% of them also facing erratic monsoons.
12. **Productivity challenges** – The combination of high heat and humidity during monsoon months hampers both human and agricultural productivity.
13. **Worsening climate dynamics** – As climate change deepens, both heat extremes and rainfall irregularities are set to intensify.
14. **Urgency for local forecasts** – The push for hyper-local, real-time weather data is becoming essential for climate resilience.
15. **Call to IMD** – The India Meteorological Department must scale up efforts to make weather data more **localised, accessible, and actionable**.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



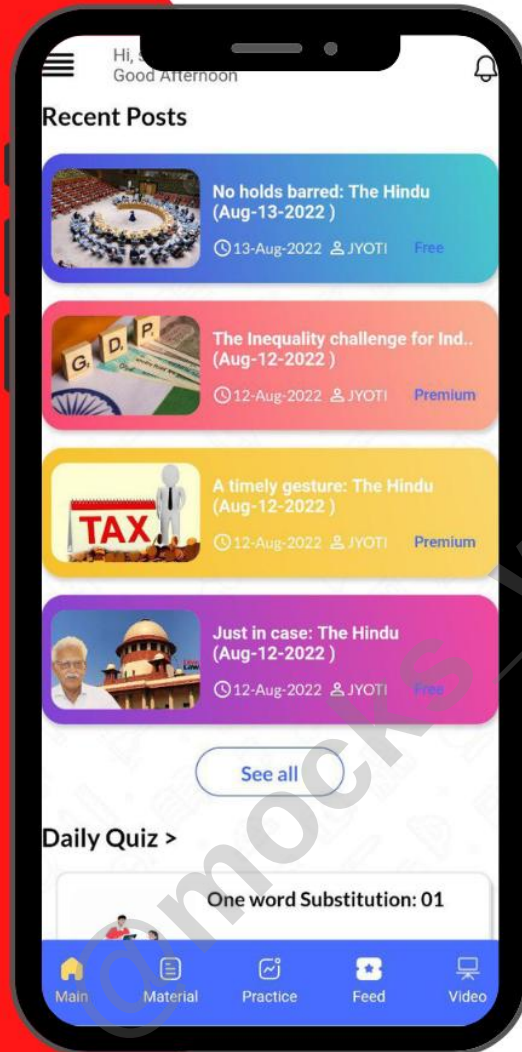
Click here to Start Quiz in the App



Click here to Start Quiz of the Editorial in the website

[Click here to download App](#)

[Click here to visit website](#)



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam